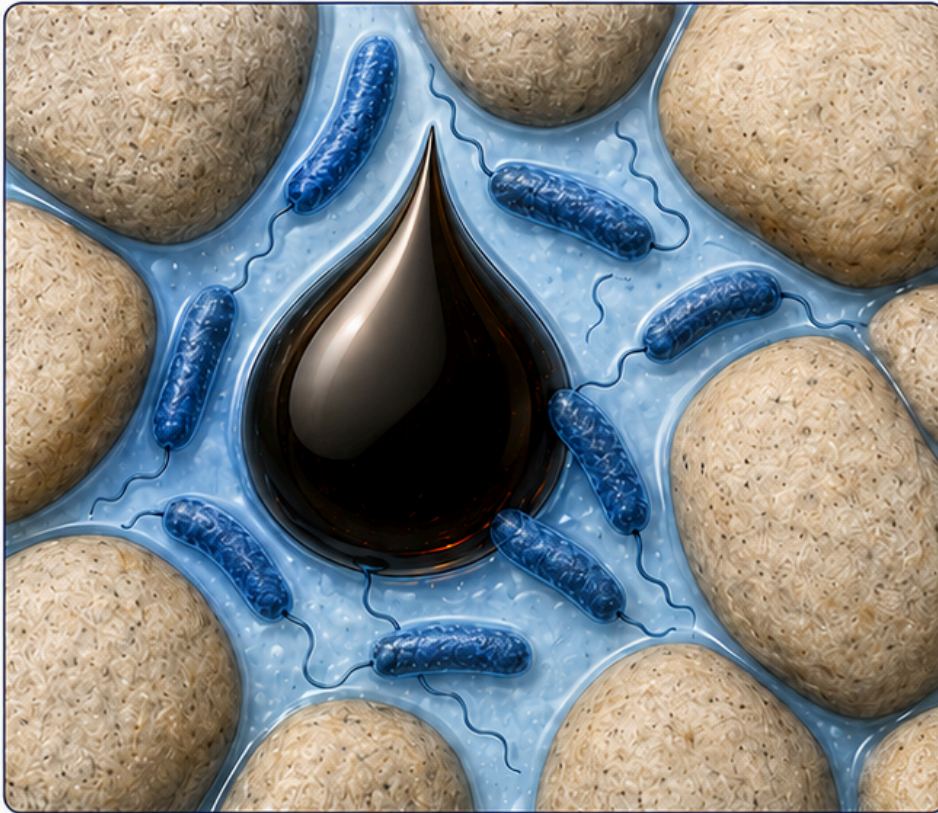


Contact depends on saturation state

Full brine saturation



Partial air saturation



Oleispira antarctica
RB-8^T



Crude oil



Brine



Sand grain



Air



Oil-microbe contact is controlled by fluid saturation and phase distribution within the pore network.